Ringier
Media Switzerland

State of Traffic

January 2026

Overview

Amid the major disruption reshaping the media industry and its traffic sources, this report outlines the current state of RMS traffic and how it is evolving over time.

Industry data shows that search traffic was down by 17% year on year (YoY) in 2025 for European publishers, whereas at RMS our biggest decrease was only 13% for Beobachter which already impressively recovered by the end of the year. For Blick FR and Cash we even recorded increases YoY.

The same industry data also showed an 18% decrease in Google Discover traffic YoY, whereas across the board we saw impressive increases here.

This is reassuring to see that with our strategies and cross-team collaboration we are able to buck the international trends.

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Traffic channels across RMS

Since the last report there has not been a significant change in terms of the traffic split for our brands. The priority remains on reducing reliance on Google traffic as much as possible by focussing on channels that build habit and loyalty with our users such as newsletters and push.

Brand	Total Sessions 2025	vs 2024	SEO	Direct (Home)	Aggregator (Non-Home)	Social	Newsletters	Push
Beobachter	9,690,517	2%	53%	7%	93%	9%	7%	0.8%
Bilanz*	2,509,756	-%	21%	9%	91%	15%	3%	-
Blick	966,645,101	-7%	35%	30%	70%	7%	1%	3%
Blick FR	54,668,791	10%	37%	20%	80%	17%	1%	3%
Cash	69,848,718	5%	37%	58%	42%	1%	5%	2%

Rows do not total 100% due to rest of traffic sources e.g. Referral, Paid etc.

Brands

Beobachter

Beobachter closed 2025 marginally up year on year, with total traffic increasing by 2% compared to 2024. This result is notable given the challenging situation mid-year, which led to the formation of the Task Force.
The overall increase was driven primarily by a strong recovery in Search during the final quarter, alongside Discover reaching an all-time high. Sessions and Pageviews in November and December were the highest recorded since at least 2022.
Although still representing a small share of total traffic, Beobachter also saw an increase in "true direct" and homepage traffic in the final quarter. This trend aligns with a rise in brand search demand over the same period.
Social traffic reached its highest level ever in 2025, driven almost entirely by Facebook.
Newsletter traffic declined in the first half of the year for a combination of factors. Following strategic optimisations, performance largely recovered in the final quarter, a trend that will be monitored closely in 2026.

Traffic Source	Total Sessions 2025	% of Total Sessions	Trend 3 months	Trend 6 months	Trend 12 months
SEO	5,122,808	53%	48%	4%	-13%
Direct / Aggregators	2,304,282	24%	126%	94%	78%
Social	855,861	9%	3%	41%	56%
Newsletters	663,799	7%	8%	-16%	-17%
Push	*75,136*	*0.8%*	*45%*	*-%*	*-%*

Bilanz

Since migrating to its own domain, Search and Discover traffic has grown steadily. This is a positive signal, particularly given the potential risk of slower traction due to Google sandboxing effects. Nevertheless, following SEO best practice and focussing on the frequency of publishing remains crucial for growth.
Referral traffic from Blick remains the most important traffic source. However, its share of total traffic has begun to decline, decreasing from 43% in Q3 to 40% in Q4.
From a newsletter perspective, Bilanz currently receives more traffic from Handelszeitung's Lunch Topics newsletter than from its own newsletters (Briefing and Watches). As a result, it remains a priority to ensure Bilanz articles are consistently featured in Lunch Topics, while simultaneously strengthening Bilanz's own newsletter subscriber base and traffic-driving performance.

Traffic Source	Total Sessions 2025	% of Total Sessions	Trend 3 months
SEO	514,883	21%	14%
Direct / Aggregators	437,533	17%	14%
Social	378,101	15%	15%
Newsletters	36,599	3%	6%
Push	-	-%	-
Referral	541,732	40%	10%

Blick

Blick ended 2025 with total sessions slightly down (7%) year on year. This was largely driven by a continued decline in “true direct” traffic since Polaris, which is also reflected in an overall slight decrease in homepage traffic. Google Discover traffic, also reported under Direct, increased over the course of the year, particularly in the second half of 2025. This indicates that the Daily Discover republishing initiative in the newsroom delivered tangible impact.

Social and Newsletter traffic represented the two largest year-on-year increases. This is a positive outcome, reflecting the significant investment in Social and new audience development in 2025, as well as the strategic importance of Newsletters as a channel to counter AI-driven traffic volatility and build stronger user habits.

Most channels saw declines in Q4, largely attributable to the news situation during the period rather than indicating a structural or longer-term negative trend.

Traffic Source	Total Sessions 2025	% of Total Sessions	Trend 3 months	Trend 6 months	Trend 12 months
SEO	336,315,923	35%	-11%	1%	-6%
Direct / Aggregators	484,910,038	50%	-8%	-17%	-19%
Social	70,554,353	7%	-14%	22%	62%
Newsletters	10,977,741	1%	-10%	53%	67%
Push	*31,109,251*	*3%*	*4%*	-	-

Blick FR

Blick FR saw a pleasing 10% increase in total traffic compared to 2024.
Search traffic saw a pronounced spike in July, which makes performance in the final quarter appear weaker by comparison rather than indicating an underlying decline.
Social traffic declined over the course of the year, driven in particular by Flipboard, with the most significant drop occurring from August onwards. A similar trend was observed for Blick (DE); however, as Flipboard represents a smaller share of traffic there, the overall impact was less pronounced.

Traffic Source	Total Sessions 2025	% of Total Sessions	Trend 3 months	Trend 6 months	Trend 12 months
SEO	20,110,864	37%	-11%	12%	18%
Direct / Aggregators	21,167,000	39%	-6%	3%	-3%
Social	9,367,944	17%	-19%	-8%	-4%
Newsletters	487,507	1%	21%	3%	137%
Push	*1,866,904*	*3%*	*19%*	-	-

Cash

Cash ended the year up 5% compared to the previous year, driven predominantly by strong Search performance. Sessions and Pageviews in March and April reached their highest levels since at least 2023, largely due to increased interest around the Trump tariff situation. October also stood out as a strong month (Gold price), with sessions ranking as the third highest of the year.

Cash's newsletters were migrated to Sailthru in the final quarter, enabling greater optimisation opportunities going forward. It is also worth noting that fewer newsletters were sent in December due to the holiday period, which had a negative impact on newsletter traffic.

The majority of Cash's traffic reported under Social is in fact driven by Google News Showcase within Google Discover, accounting for 49% of Social traffic. Google Analytics attributes News Showcase to Social rather than Direct or Search, unlike regular Discover traffic. Interestingly, Showcase plays a significantly smaller role for the other brands where it is live.

Traffic Source	Total Sessions 2025	% of Total Sessions	Trend 3 months	Trend 6 months	Trend 12 months
SEO	26,056,979	37%	6%	-7%	28%
Direct / Aggregators	37,258,047	53%	-14%	-13%	-4%
Social	754,259	1%	-4%	30%	51%
Newsletters	3,507,015	5%	0%	-9%	-2%
Push	*1,268,714*	*2%*	*50%*	-	-

Channels

SEO (Search)

It is very encouraging to see Beobachter's recovery in the second half of the year, particularly in Q4, where Search traffic increased significantly. In parallel, Beobachter's share of brand search traffic rose from 2 to 6%, indicating strengthening brand demand.

A similar fluctuation pattern can be observed for both Blick and Cash, in that during periods of major news or financial events, such as Blick in May (Pope and Blatten) and September (ESAF), or Cash in April (tariffs) and October (gold), overall Search traffic increases alongside a higher share of brand searches. This suggests that users are actively seeking out Blick and Cash by name, reflecting trust in their reporting and perspectives.

These event-driven peaks can, however, distort trend interpretation, as the subsequent months may appear to decline when they are in fact normalisations following periods of unusually high interest.

Brand	Total Sessions 2025	% of Total Sessions	Trend 3 months	Trend 6 months	Trend 12 months	Brand %
Beobachter	5,122,808	53%	48%	4%	-13%	6%
Bilanz*	514,883	21%	14%	-%	-%	7%
Blick	336,315,923	35%	-11%	1%	-6%	68%
Blick FR	20,110,864	37%	-11%	12%	18%	42%
Cash	26,056,979	37%	6%	-7%	28%	3%

Direct / News Aggregators (Google Discover)

Beobachter's growth in Direct traffic is primarily driven by strong performance in Google Discover. This is largely the result of the editorial team consistently applying SEO recommendations for republishing, as well as Nathan takeovers from Cash in the final quarter.
Blick and Cash remain in the strongest positions in terms of "true direct" traffic, defined as visits to the homepage. For Blick, the slight decline in Direct traffic is mainly attributable to a decrease in "true direct" homepage sessions. In contrast, Cash's decline is driven by fluctuations in Discover traffic, where pronounced peaks in April and August skew the overall trend.

Brand	Total Sessions 2025	% of Total Sessions	Trend 3 months	Trend 6 months	Trend 12 months	Homepage %	Non-Home % (Aggregator)
Beobachter	2,304,282	24%	126%	94%	78%	6%	94%
Bilanz*	437,533	17%	14%	-%	-%	9%	91%
Blick	484,910,038	50%	-8%	-17%	-19%	74%	26%
Blick FR	21,167,000	39%	-6%	3%	-3%	36%	64%
Cash	37,258,047	53%	-14%	-13%	-4%	60%	40%

Social

Overall, Social traffic performed well across the brands in 2025, with Beobachter in particular recording its strongest year to date.
Across all brands*, Facebook remains by far the most important source of social traffic. During the first three quarters of the year, we saw a clear turnaround, with Facebook once again rewarding news content. In the final quarter, performance softened, suggesting either a dip or a normalisation in reach and traffic. This will be monitored closely as we move into 2026.
*The exception is Blick, where traffic generated via WhatsApp shares represents the largest share of Social traffic.

Brand	Total Sessions 2025	% of Total Sessions	Trend 3 months	Trend 6 months	Trend 12 months	Own Pages %	Shares %	Referral %
Beobachter	855,861	9%	3%	41%	56%	94%	0.3%	6%
Bilanz*	378,101	15%	15%	-%	-%	95%	0.3%	4%
Blick	70,554,353	7%	-14%	22%	62%	29%	70%	1%
Blick FR	9,367,944	17%	-19%	-8%	-4%	44%	24%	32%
Cash	754,259	1%	-4%	30%	51%	24%	6%	69%

Newsletter

As highlighted in the brand slides, Beobachter experienced a challenging start to 2025, with performance then improving towards the final quarter.
Cash has similarly seen a period of stagnation; however, with the Sailthru migration now complete, there is a strong opportunity to reverse this trend.
It is also important to note that several newsletters were paused briefly during the holiday period at the end of the quarter, contributing to a slight decline in newsletter-driven traffic.

Brand	Total Sessions 2025	% of Total Sessions	Trend 3 months	Trend 6 months	Trend 12 months
Beobachter	663,799	7%	8%	-16%	-17%
Bilanz*	36,599	3%	6%	-%	-%
Blick	10,977,741	1%	-10%	53%	67%
Blick FR	487,507	1%	21%	3%	137%
Cash	3,507,015	5%	0%	-9%	-2%

Push

Push notifications continue to grow as a source of traffic across almost all brands.
For Beobachter, push frequency was increased as part of Task Force measures, which has delivered clear traffic growth. While push traffic still represents a relatively small share of total traffic, this performance highlights a clear opportunity for further growth, particularly if app downloads and activation receive greater focus in 2026.
For brands that do not yet use browser push, this remains a clear growth opportunity for 2026.

Brand	Total Sessions 2025	% of Total Sessions	Trend 3 months	App %	Browser %
Beobachter	75,136	0.8%	45%	100%	-%
Bilanz*	-	-	-	-	-
Blick	31,109,251	3%	4%	97%	4%
Blick FR	1,866,904	3%	19%	91%	9%
Cash	1,268,714	2%	50%	100%	-

Traffic Strategy considerations

Traffic Strategy

The Strategy remains the same as last year, grouped in two broad areas; optimising our presence in AI while mitigating losses by building up more resilient, healthy traffic. Examples of key ongoing initiatives include:

Optimise presence in AI

- Increase presence on websites/platforms heavily quoted by AI e.g. YouTube & Reddit
- Focus on content that cannot be as easily summarised by AI or has a stronger reason for a user to still click to the source e.g.
    - Exclusives
    - Long-form research or rankings
    - Audio & Video
    - Tools
    - Games/Puzzles

Mitigate losses from AI

- New Users/Brand discovery - Google Discover / Social Media
- Loyalty/habit building & retention
    - Community-building focus e.g. via Quizzes, Commenting, Blick Check, Follow my Team, Börsenspiel etc
    - Newsletter portfolio expansions and optimisations
    - Optimisation / introduction of topic alerts via email and/or push
    - App push strategy optimisation and introduction of web push

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Thank you for your time